

Chapter 6

Flow Control in Assembly Exercises

Z. Gu

Fall 2025

Pseudocode to Assembly

- ▶ Write assembly program for pseudocode, one version without Conditional Execution instructions, one version with Conditional Execution.

Pseudocode	Assembly Program
if (r0 != r1) r2 = r2 + r2	

Pseudocode	Assembly Program w/Conditional Execution
if (r0 != r1) r2 = r2 + r2	

Pseudocode to Assembly

- ▶ Write assembly program for pseudocode.

Pseudocode	Assembly Program 1
<code>r1 = (r0 >> 4) & 15</code>	

Assembly Program Understanding

- ▶ What is r0 equal to after running this program:
 - ▶ MOV r0, #10
 - ▶ MOV r1, #7
 - ▶ MOV r2, #5
 - ▶ CMP r1, r2
 - ▶ ADDGT r0, r0, #100

C to Assembly

- ▶ Write the equivalent assembly program for this piece of code in C.
- ▶ `save[]` is an array of 32-bit integers. Assume that `i` and `k` correspond to registers `r1` and `r2`, and the base of the array `save` is in `r0`. Write assembly code corresponding to this C code.

C code	Assembly Program
<code>while (save[i] == k)</code> <code>i += 1;</code>	<code>; r0 = &save[0]</code> (base address of array) <code>; r1 = i</code> (index) <code>; r2 = k</code> (value to compare) <code>...</code>

C to Assembly

- ▶ Write the equivalent assembly program for this piece of code in C.

C code	Assembly Program
<pre>for (i=0; i<8; i++){ a[i] = b[7-i]; }</pre>	<pre>; Assume r0 = base address of a, r1 = base address of b</pre>

C to Assembly: What is wrong?

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 1; while (cnt <= 10) { // loop body cnt++; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #1 ; cnt = 1 loop: CMP r0, #10 ; Compare x0 with 10 while x0 <=10 BEQ end ; If cnt == 10, branch to end ADD r0, r0, #1 ; cnt = cnt + 1 B loop ; Repeat the loop done:</pre>

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 10; while (cnt != 0) { // loop body cnt--; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #10 ; remaining iterations loop: ; loop body SUB r0, r0, #1 ; cnt--; sets flags BNE loop ; repeat until cnt == 0 (10 times) done:</pre>

C to Assembly

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 1; while (cnt <= 10) { // loop body cnt++; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #1 ; cnt = 1 loop: ; loop body ADD ??? ; cnt++ CMP ??? BLE ??? ; while (cnt <= 10) continue done:</pre>

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 10; while (cnt != 0) { // loop body cnt--; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #10 ; remaining iterations loop: ; loop body SUBS ??? ; cnt--; sets Z flag if r0=0 BNE ??? ; repeat until cnt == 0 (10 times) done:</pre>

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 10; while (cnt > 0) { // loop body cnt--; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #10 ; remaining iterations loop: ; loop body SUBS ???; cnt--; sets Z flag if r0=0 BGT ??? ; repeat until cnt == 0 (10 times) done:</pre>

C to Assembly: What is wrong?

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int cnt = 10; while (cnt > 0) { // loop body cnt--; }</pre>	<pre>MOV r0, #10 ; remaining iterations loop: ; loop body SUBS r0, r0, #1 ; cnt--; sets Z flag if r0=0 BPL loop ; repeat until cnt == 0 (10 times) done:</pre>

C to Assembly

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int array[200]; int i; for (i = 199; i >= 0; i = i - 1) { array[i] = array[i] * 8; }</pre>	<pre>% R0 = base address of array, R1 = i MOV R0, 0x60000000 ; base address where array resides MOV R1, #199 ; i = 199 ...</pre>

C to Assembly

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>//Calculate x such that 2^x=128 int pow = 1; int x = 0; while (pow != 128) { pow = pow * 2; x = x + 1; }</pre>	<pre>; r0 = pow, r1 = x MOV r0, #1 ; pow = 1 MOV r1, #0 ; x = 0 WHILE DONE</pre>

C to Assembly

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>int array[200]; int i; for (i = 199; i >= 0; i=i-1) array[i] = array[i] * 8;</pre>	<pre>; R0 = array base address, R1 = i MOV R0, 0x60000000 MOV R1, #199 FOR</pre>

- ▶ For an array of 32-bit ints, each element is 4 bytes, so element i lives at $\text{base} + i * 4$, which is implemented as $\text{base} + (i \ll 2)$ via `LSL #2` in the addressing mode
- ▶ BPL “Branch if PLus” branches when the N (negative) flag $N == 0$, meaning the prior result was positive or zero

Assembly Programming

- ▶ Write a program that reverses the bits in a register, such that the register containing d31,d30,d29...d1,d0 now contains d0,d1,...d29,d30,d31.

Test for Equal

- ▶ Give the different methods to test if two values held in registers `r0` and `r1` are equal.

Summary: Condition Codes

Suffix	Description	Flags tested
EQ	E Qual	Z=1
NE	N ot E qual	Z=0
CS/HS	Unsigned H igher or S ame	C=1
CC/LO	Unsigned L ower	C=0
MI	M Inus (Negative)	N=1
PL	P Lus (Positive or Zero)	N=0
VS	o V erflow S et	V=1
VC	o V erflow C leared	V=0
HI	Unsigned H Igher	C=1 & Z=0
LS	Unsigned L ower or S ame	C=0 or Z=1
GE	Signed G reater or E qual	N=V
LT	Signed L ess T han	N!=V
GT	Signed G reater T han	Z=0 & N=V
LE	Signed L ess than or E qual	Z=1 or N!=V
AL	A Lways	

Note AL is the default and does not need to be specified

Conditional Instructions

- ▶ Write the following ARMv7 instructions:
 - ▶ Add registers r3 and r6 only if N is clear (from a previous instruction). Store the result in register r7.
 - ▶ Multiply registers r7 and r12, put the results in register r3 only if C is set and Z is clear (from a previous instruction)
 - ▶ Compare registers r6 and r8 only if Z is clear (from a previous instruction)

Assembly to C

- Write the equivalent C program for the following assembly code, assuming registers and C variables are related as ($x=r0, y=r1$). (Variables in C are in memory, and load/store assembly instructions are omitted here for brevity.) For example:

Assembly Program	C Program
CMP r0, #5 MOVEQ r0, #10 BLEQ fn	if (x == 5) { x = 10; fn(x); }
Assembly Program	C Program
CMP r0, #0 MOVLE r0, #0 MOVGT r0, #1	
Assembly Program	C rogram
CMP r0, #'A' CMPNE r0, #'B' MOVEQ r1, #1	

Conditional Execution

- Rewrite the assembly program to use conditional execution statements.

Assembly Program	Assembly Program with Cond. Exec
CMP r3, #0 BEQ next ADD r0, r0, r1 SUB r0, r0, r2 next ...	